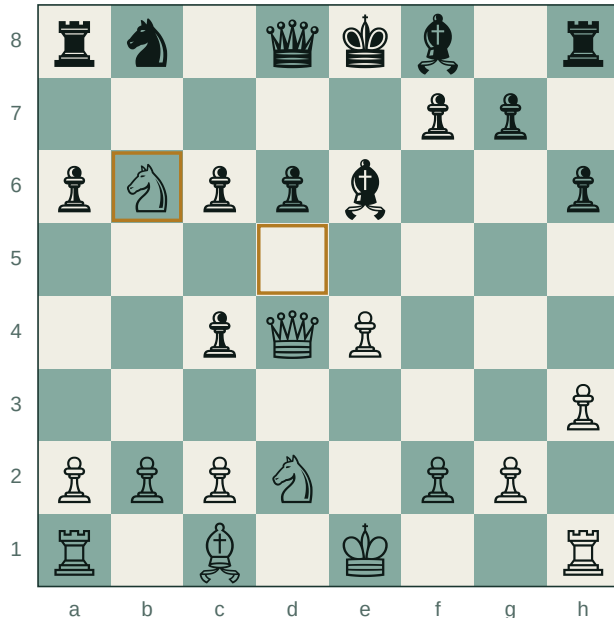


Interference tactics: Black, move 12

Interference tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 12.Nb6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

12...c5 13. Qc3 Qxb6

12...c5 The pawn moves from c6 to c5. Recorded reply: **13.Qc3**.

13...Qxb6 The queen captures the knight on b6.

At the end, nominal material is White 32 / Black 35 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +3:** the balance goes from +0 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Capturing the interposing piece may restore defense. Calculate which captures are legal and whether they permit another tactic.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Interference interrupts a defensive line between enemy pieces. Occupying one square can make a previously protected target vulnerable or prevent an important recapture.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the defender's line to its target and inspect forcing moves onto the intervening squares.

The defending king is on e1. Geometrically undefended: queen on d4 and rook on h1. Check for tactical protection.